

Note: please key in your updates in red.

PENGUIN RANDOM HOUSE INDIA STYLE GUIDE

Additional style guide elements to keep in mind:

- judgment without e for cases
- judgement with e for other instances
- ***Adjectives positioning***
- Opinion or quality of noun> size>age> shape>color>origin or material>a qualifier. But before stating adjectives of quality the adjectives of quantity or numeral adjectives must be there. All these are used as per the availability and need of the description of a noun in a sentence.
- ***Adjectives arrangement:***
- opinion-size-age-shape-colour-origin-material-purpose noun
- him and me
- he and I
- us and me
- we and I
- ***Citing Penguin in footnotes:***
- Pre-2013 (merger): Penguin Books India, New Delhi
- 2014 onwards: PRHI, Gurgaon
- North-east, North-eastern states, north-eastern direction
- *The Economist, The Times, The Hindu*: only these three instances will the *The* be capitalized and italicized
- Wire, Firstpost, Livemint, ThePrint, Quint: all in roman
- *India Today, Week, DNA: in italics*

- Indian Subcontinent (7 countries): India, Pakistan, Bangladesh, Sri Lanka, Nepal, Bhutan and the Maldives.
- To find acronyms in Word: <[A-Z]{2,}> (in Wildcard mode)
- To find straight apostrophes in Word, you'd type: ^39
- You use ^34 to find straight double quotes
- Italics (of vernacular, local words and those not found in the OED) on the first appearance only
- Food items, names of trees etc. are not italicized
- How songs are treated: 'The Continental', 'Night and Day', 'Norwegian Wood'
- NUMBER RANGES ARE DENOTED BY EN DASHES, NOT HYPHENS

Guide to capitalizing headlines:

Capitalize

Don't capitalize

Prepositions	in, on, like, at, of, by, for, into, with, from, between, beyond, about, than, without, against
Articles	a, an, the
Conjunctions	and, but, if, or, than, yet
Pronoun	it, this, these, those, that, what, her, who, his, us, oneself, any
Verb	is, was, be, am, are, were, being, been, should

Determiner	its, his, any, my
Adverb	as, up, not

GLOBALS:

Check for double spaces, double quotes, space before a comma, space before a full stop, space before a quotation mark, spaces before en dash, em dash and hyphens

Check for British spellings; look out for:

- ise (lise, nise, tise, sise, vise, mise, gise, rise, dise)
- isa (lisa, nisa, tisa, misa, risa)
- isi (tisi, gisi, nisi, sisi, misi, visi, risi)
- thise (sympathize)
- yse, yze
- or (lor, vor, bor, nor)
- our, tt, ll, tre, ter, nce, nse, tice, tise, cuss
- Space before every footnote begins
- Dots between initials
- 2016 —
- Period dots before FNs
- zero to
- numbers

- sub- - lakh not lakhs - crore not crores
Curly quotes not copy-pasted ones (") For example, to find straight apostrophes in Word, you'd type: ^39 You use ^34 to find straight double quotes.
Check ellipsis (there should be one space between each dot)
Check double dots
Check double quotes (we only use single quotes to begin with, and double quotes for a quote within a quote)
per cent, NOT % or percent
Mr, Mrs, Ms, Dr, the Internet, YouTube, WhatsApp: correct spellings
... ..
’

” .
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Abbreviations

- An abbreviation that is a contraction, i.e. that retains its first and last letters, should appear without a stop, e.g. Mr, Ms, Mrs, Dr, St (for street and Saint).
- But an abbreviation that does not retain its original last letter must appear with a stop, e.g. Prof., Maj., Capt.
- For abbreviated names, there are stops but no spaces between initials, but a space after, e.g. A.P.J. Abdul Kalam.
- There are stops in etc., e.g., i.e.
- There are no stops in measurements, e.g. 7 cm, 11 kg
- There are stops after abbreviated names of parts of a book, e.g. vol. 5(Or v. 5), no. 3, sec. 11, p. 92.
- Do not use abbreviations like lit. crit for literary criticism.
- Do not use & in place of and except in an abbreviation. Thus, Jammu and Kashmir not Jammu & Kashmir, but J & K, not J and K.
- Educational degrees like BA, MA, MBBS, BTech, MPhil and PhD are used abbreviated but with no stops.
- There are no stops in abbreviated names of states like UP, MP, HP, WB.
- It is fine to use commonly understood abbreviations like USA and UK or TV (not tv) and CD (not cd).
- But abbreviations like CBI or NASA should be spelt out on first appearance and abbreviated thereafter.
- Party names like BJP, VHP, CPI and AIADMK should be spelt out on first appearance.
- Organizational or institutional names like DRDO, PMO, SAIL, TELCO etc. should be spelt out on first appearance.
- For PM, CM, MP, MLA etc. the full form should be used where the use is sparing.

Bias, Libel, Parochialism

- Bias (typically gender bias or sectarian bias) is easy to spot and rectify. Evaluative judgements made on the basis of a person's gender and about the class/caste/regional identity of an individual or group should always be interrogated. Gender neutrality in particular must be striven for in a culture that is still coded in patriarchy. A country, ship or nature should be referred to as 'it', not 'she'.
- Parochialism is sometimes more difficult to identify because it tends to perpetuate clichés arising from an insular, narrow-minded view of proceedings. Parochialism based on class, religion and regional identity should be watched out for, in particular.
- Libel constitutes of a questionable or legally objectionable statement tending to discredit a person or persons that the publisher can be sued for. These should be carefully identified and cleared with a lawyer before publication.

Capitalization

Capitals should be used sparingly, but the following instances demand them:

- Titular heads like the President (of a country). However, say the president of an organization. Note that chief justice, chief minister and prime minister should either be all lower case or all upper case. Secretary (as a government official) is upper case while minister is lower case. Example, the President of the United States v/s the president of a local organization.
- Also, the Speaker, the Governor, the Parliament, the Supreme Court, a specific high court (e.g. 'Patna High Court', but 'the high court'), the Lok Sabha and the Rajya Sabha. For MLAs and MPs, the full forms are members of Parliament and members of the Legislative Assembly.
- Union as in the Union cabinet, the Union finance ministry. Centre as in the Central government. The Constitution. Articles of the Constitution. Note that ministries, governments and assemblies are lower case.
- The Opposition, as in 'leader of the Opposition'.
- The Valley, when referring to Kashmir.
- God as in the Christian divinity. But 'gods' are lower case.
- Independence and Partition, when referring to the actual event that took place in 1947.

- Community names like Muslim and Brahmin. But scheduled caste, adivasi. Where identity is politicized it should be in caps, e.g. Harijans, Dalits.
- Trade names like Xerox, Boeing, Pepsi.
- Full names of organizations like the Council for Scientific and Industrial Research. Can subsequently be referred to as the council.
- Political persuasions like communism, fascism, socialism are lower case. Marxism is capitalized.
- A geographical region is not capitalized. Thus, south India, east Bengal.
- When a designation is used as an adjective, it is capitalized. Thus, Defence Minister George Fernandes. But, former defence minister Arun Singh.

Currencies and Calculations

- The units are thousands, lakh and crore for India, and million elsewhere. The house style is Rs 5 lakh, and ‘Rs 5-lakh deficit’ (where the amount is used as an adjective). There is no stop after Rs but there is a space between the currency and the amount, e.g. Rs 450. For pound, sterling and dollars, however, there is no space (£45, \$70).

Dates

- The house style is 15 August 1947; 15 August; and August 1947, with no commas separating the day, month and year.

Indian Words

- Commonly understood words from Hindi and other major Indian languages should not be italicized; they should be integrated into the text and not made to stand out.
- There can of course be some debate over what is a commonly understood word, and to whom. If there is doubt about the meaning of a word, it should always be explained in its context in the text.
- Sentences or part-sentences in a regional language should always be italicized and the meaning given in parenthesis.
- Footnotes explaining the meaning of Indian words should be avoided at all costs since they draw unnecessary attention to the ‘alienness’ of vernacular words. Italicization on first appearance is equally unacceptable for the same reasons. A glossary may be provided, if necessary, but it is better to try to

explain the meaning in the text itself. Alternately, notes (not footnotes) on the text can be incorporated.

- An unnecessary pile-up of Indian words and expressions, especially where these interfere with the meaning being understood, is to be avoided.

Italicization

- Words and phrases from foreign languages that are in common use in English should not be italicized. Thus, *nouveau riche*, *ad nauseam*, etc. should be Rom. Foreign words and phrases that are not commonly understood should be avoided altogether.
- The name of a complete work, e.g. a book, a film, a newspaper, a television show, a symphony, is italicized.
- The name of an article, essay etc., is not italicized but put within quotes. Note: when italicizing the name of a periodical, do not italicize the initial 'the' even if it is part of the periodical's printed title (e.g. the *Times of India*).
- Oral epics like the Iliad, the Odyssey, the Ramayana and the Mahabharata are Rom, as is the Bible.

Numbers

- 0 to 99 will be spelt out as zero to ninety-nine.
- Numbers beyond twenty will be hyphenated, e.g. 'fifty-one'.
- Numbers from 100 onward will be written in figures.
- Figures beyond 10,000 will be separated by commas for every two digits, e.g. 20,000, 1,20,000, 12,20,000.
- Sport scores are always in figures, e.g. 7 runs, 1 over, 15 points.
- Percentages are in figures, e.g. 82.3 per cent. (Per cent is two words. Do not use %)
- Continuous numbers are in double digits. Thus, 9–11, 15–17, 29–33, 98–101, 117–19, 125–32. Also, for dates, 1899–1947, 1911–14, 1947–84, 1999–2001, 2002–04, etc.

Punctuation

- Refer to the *Penguin Guide to Punctuation*.
- Briefly, commas are of four types:

- The listing/serial/Oxford comma is used in a list where *and* or *or* would be possible instead. Example: I bought apples, oranges, and bananas.
- The joining comma is used before *and*, *or*, *but*, *yet* or *while* when they join two complete sentences. Example: I wanted to go for a walk, but it started raining.
- The gapping comma is used to show that words have been omitted instead of repeated. Example: She likes hiking; he, swimming.
- A pair of bracketing commas is used to set off a weak interruption. Example: My brother, who lives in London, is visiting us next week.
- Semi-colons should be used to distinguish disparate sections of a long sentence.
- Em dashes (—) should be used to demarcate a parenthetical part of a sentence or a digression from the main argument. There should be no spaces before and after an em dash.
- En dashes (–) should be used not as substitutes for em dashes but only in place of a hyphen when the two quantities separated are equal and/or reciprocal, e.g. the 1914–18 war, the Mumbai–Pune road, the Nehru–Gandhi family. For the year 1998–99 etc., use an en dash.
- An ellipsis of three separated points, with a space before and after (. . .) is used to indicate breaks in speech or argument.
- For parentheses, a single bracket () should be used. For parenthesis within parenthesis, square brackets [] should be used.

Quotes

- The Penguin style for quotations is to use single quote (‘ ’) marks.
- For quotes within quotes, double quote marks (“ ”) are to be used.
- For quotes within quotes within quotes, single quote marks are to be used again.
- Where a complete sentence is quoted, the closing quote mark should come after the stop (. ’). Where a phrase or a section of a sentence is quoted, the closing quote mark should come before the stop (. ’).
- Language should not be changed to Penguin specifications within quoted sections.
- An ellipsis of three separated points with a space before and after (. . .) should be used to indicate breaks in quoted material.

- Quoted material longer than fifty words and poetry longer than two lines should be set apart from the text (in smaller point size where necessary) and indented one em on both sides.
- Permissions for quoted material longer than 100 words should be obtained well in advance.

Time

- ce and bce: both are in small caps, with no stops separating the letters.
- a.m. and p.m.: always lower case, and with stops after both letters. It is always better to say 6 a.m. or 6 p.m. than 6 o'clock, which is vague.
- Do not use the 24-hour clock, as in '1800 hours' unless the context specifically demands it.
- The hour and minutes in '6.45 p.m.' should be separated by a stop and not a colon.

SPELLING AND CORRECT USAGE

Ground Rules of Spelling

- 'z' rather than 's' and '-ize' rather than '-ise'. Thus, 'organization' not 'organisation'; 'standardize' not 'standardise'.

However, the following words must be spelt -ise, not -ize:

advertise	franchise
apprise	merchandise
braise	premise
chastise	prise
circumcise	reprise
comprise	revise
despise	supervise

devise	surmise
enterprise	surprise
exercise	televise

- Also, analyse, catalyse, paralyse etc. should be spelt -yse, not -yze.
- British rather than American spellings.
- Thus, -ae- rather than -e- in anaemia, archaeology etc.
- ce rather than -se in defence, offence, pretence etc.
- em- and en- rather than im- and in- in embed, enclose etc.
- l- rather than -ll- in fulfil, instalment, skilful, wilful etc.
- ll- rather than -l- in marvellous, woollen etc.
- lled and -ller rather than -led and -ler in travelled, traveller etc.
- ou- rather than -o- in mould, honour, labour etc.
- oue- rather than -eu- in manoeuvre etc.
- que- rather than -ck- in cheque, chequered etc.
- re rather than -er in calibre, centre, litre, kilometre, sombre, theatre etc.

Troublesome Words

Affect/Effect	Affect means to act upon or influence. To effect is to produce or accomplish.
All right	Not 'alright'.
Along with	Not 'alongwith'.
Among/between	Between emphasizes the individual, among the group. Logically, between should be used to indicate reciprocal relationships, and among collective ones.
Any more	Not 'anymore'.
Any time	Not 'anytime'.
Anything, anywhere, anyway, anyone	One word.

Appraise/Apprise	Appraise means to evaluate, set a price on. Apprise means to inform.
Benefited/Benefiting	Not benefitted/benefitting.
Bi-monthly/-weekly	Avoid using, since the meaning is ambiguous.
Can, may, will, shall	Can apply to what is possible; may applies to what is permissible; will expresses simple futurity; shall expresses a sense of definitiveness and determination.
Careen/career	For a runaway vehicle, to careen is to sway or tilt dangerously. Career refers simply to uncontrolled movement.
Celibacy	Refers to marital status, not to sexual abstinence.
Centre on	Not ‘centre around’, as common parlance has it. You can circle around something, but centering around something is physically impossible.
Compare to/with	Compare to is used to liken things, compare with to consider their similarities and differences.
Complacent/complaisant	If you are complacent, you are pleased with yourself. If you are complaisant, you are eager to please others.
Comprise	Is not followed by of, unlike consist and compose. The whole comprises the parts.
Confidant	Applies only to a man. A woman would be a confidante.

Continual/continuous	Continual refers to things that happen repeatedly but not constantly; continuous indicates an unbroken sequence.
Country, nation	Country refers to geographical identity, nation to political and social identity.
Dangling modifier	Can cause much amusement, but often goes undetected. Is typically caused by an unattached present participle. Example: 'Handing me my whisky, his face broke into a smile', which conjures up the image of a face that can pass a whisky. Should be rewritten as: 'As he handed me my whisky, his face broke into a smile.'
Data	Is actually plural, but is generally used as singular: no one says 'datum' any more. It is best to avoid constructions like 'The data show/shows that . . . '
Decimate	Literal meaning: reduce by a tenth. Should never be used to indicate annihilation.
Defuse/diffuse	To defuse is to quickly and completely allay, as in defusing a bomb. To diffuse is to distribute evenly and therefore diminish.
Dependant/dependent	Dependant is the noun, dependent the adjective.
Deprecate/depreciate	To depreciate is to decrease the importance of something. To deprecate is to disapprove strongly.
De rigueur	Not 'de rigneur'.

Different	One thing is different from another; not different to.
Dilemma, Hobson's choice	Both are often misused. To be in a dilemma is to be faced with two options, both of which are unsatisfactory. A Hobson's choice is no choice at all.
Disinterested	Is not the same as uninterested. Disinterested means impartial, unbiased.
Empathy/sympathy	Empathy with; sympathy for.
Every day/Everyday	Everyday is one word only when used as an adjective, e.g. 'everyday occurrence'.
Farther/further	Farther refers to literal (and therefore measurable) distance, further to figurative distance.
Fiancé	A man whom one is engaged to. The female version is fiancée.
Flaunt/Flout	To flaunt is to show off. To flout is to mock or insult.
Flounder/founder	To founder is to sink. To flounder is to flail about helplessly.
Forbear/forebear	To forbear is to abstain. A forebear is an ancestor.
Forever/for ever	'For ever' refers to a very long period of time, 'ever' being the measurement of that time. 'Forever' means always.
Forego/forgo	To forego is to precede. To forgo is to do without.

Fortuitous	Means accidental. Has nothing to do with 'fortunate'.
Fulsome	Does not mean lavish or wholesome as is often supposed, but odious, overfull.
Graffiti	Is plural. The singular is graffito.
Homogenous/-geneous	Homogenous means of common ancestry. Homogeneous refers to uniformity.
Hour, heir, honest, honour	The only words starting with h where the h is silent, and which need to be preceded by an, rather than a. Historian/historical and hotel should be preceded by a, not an.
Inchoate	Means nascent, incipient, not disorganized.
Ingenious/Ingenuous	Ingenious means skilful, clever. Ingenuous means frank, free from deception.
Insidious/invidious	Insidious indicates the stealthy spread of something undesirable. Invidious means offensive.
In spite of	Not 'inspite of'.
Its/It's	The most common mistake still. 'Its' is the possessive form of 'it'; 'it's' is an abbreviation for 'it is'.
Just deserts	Not 'just desserts'. The phrase refers to what one deserves, and has nothing to do with food.
Leitmotif	Not leitmotiv.
Licence/license	Licence is the noun, license the verb.

Light years	A measure of distance, not time.
Media	Though actually plural of medium, this can safely be used as singular.
Men's, women's, children's	The apostrophe should come before the s, since the words are already plural.
Mixed metaphors	Almost invariably the result of ignoring the literal meaning of a sentence because it sounds good. A lot of 'good' writing—Shakespeare's, for instance—is full of mixed metaphors, e.g. 'take arms against a sea of troubles'. Some mixed metaphors can be pretty offensive: 'This is a virgin territory pregnant with possibilities'. It's an editor's job to remove such problematic constructions and clean the language up.
Nauseous/nauseated	Nauseous can be used to describe something that nauseates one, not to describe the state of nausea. 'I am feeling nauseous' is as wrong as 'I am feeling poisonous'.
Neither ... nor	'Neither' has to be followed by 'nor'; it cannot be followed by 'or'.
Non sequiturs	A combination of two or more unrelated statements, often resulting from the urge to pack in too much information into one sentence. Example: 'A resident of Vasant Vihar, he was tall, handsome and drove a red Maruti.' The three parts of this sentence have nothing to do with each other. Non sequiturs can make

otherwise good writing look ridiculous, and should be avoided at all costs.

No sooner ... than

If a sentence begins with 'no sooner', it *has* to continue with 'than', otherwise the construction makes no sense.

Not only ... but

If a sentence begins with 'not only', it *has to* continue with 'but' and not some other conjunction.

On to/onto

Avoid using 'onto' as one word.

Perspicacity/perspicuity

Perspicacity means shrewdness and applies to people; perspicuity means easily understood and applies to things.

Practice/Practise

Practice is the noun, practise the verb.

Principal/principle

Principle means 'fundamental' and is always a noun. Principal means 'of first importance' and can be used both as noun and adjective.

Prodigal/prodigious

Prodigal means recklessly wasteful. Prodigious means immense.

Prophecy/prophesy

Prophecy is the noun, prophesy the verb.

Prototype

A prototype is the original model on which all later models and variations are based. Not any role model can be referred to as prototype.

Pyrrhic victory

Not a hollow victory, but one won at great cost.

Rack/wrack

Wrack is simply an old-fashioned word for wreck. Often when we use

wrack we mean rack, which is to put under strain. Thus, the correct expressions are: ‘a world racked by political crisis’, ‘nerve-racking’ and ‘to rack one’s brains’.

Riveted/Riveting

Not rivetted/rivetting.

Sensual/sensuous

Sensuous means being alive to sensations, specifically not sexual, which sensual connotes.

Shambles

‘In a shambles’, not ‘in shambles’.

Some time/Sometime

One word, except when ‘some’ is being used as a separate adjective.

Split infinitive

Refer to *Troublesome Words*. Bryson quotes Partridge: ‘Avoid the split infinitive wherever possible; but if it is the clearest and most natural construction, use it boldly. The angels are on our side’.

Stationary/Stationery

Stationary means something that is at a standstill. Stationery is paper, pen, etc.

Travel up/down

Something that is usually not paid attention to. To travel up is to travel north; to travel down is to travel south. So you can travel up from Delhi to Chandigarh but must travel down from Mumbai to Bangalore. This gets confusing with trains because any train headed towards Delhi, including those originating from Jammu or Amritsar, are Up trains. In such cases it’s safer to avoid using up/down altogether.

Turbid/turgid

Turbid means impenetrable. Turgid means inflated, grandiloquent.

Venal/venial

Venal means corruptible. Venial means excusable. A venial sin is a minor one.

Who/whom

Whom is used when it is the object of a preposition ('to whom it may concern') or verb ('the man whom we saw last night'). Who is used in all other cases.

Hyphenated Words/One Word/Two Words

The list of standardized hyphenations/one word/two words is too lengthy to be included here. Please consult the Oxford Dictionary for Writers and Editors whenever in doubt. Most usages of hyphenation will also be found to be standardized in Penguin India publications. Interpretations of what should be hyphenated or one word/two words is often somewhat subjective, and often variant usages are not necessarily incorrect. What is crucial is that these usages be completely consistent within a particular text.

Penguin India Standardized Spellings

For the following words, more than one correct spelling exists in the English language. In order to standardize usage, Penguin India has chosen the following variants for its house style.

acknowledgement not acknowledgment

advisable not adviseable

adviser not advisor

ageing	not aging
appendices	not appendixes
arguable	not argueable
artefact	not artifact
by-law	not bye-law
centring	not centering
connection	not connexion
dispatch	not despatch
encyclopedia	not encyclopaedia
focused	not focussed.
grey	not gray
gypsy	not gipsy
guerrilla	not guerilla
inflection	not inflexion
inquiry	not enquiry
judgement	not judgment (but use judgment in legal works)
medieval	not mediaeval
movable	not moveable (but use moveable in legal works)
normality	not normalcy
programme	not program (but computer program)
reflection	not reflexion
sceptical	not skeptical
storey	not story

towards	not toward
veranda	not verandah

Commonly Misspelt Words

The following is a list of commonly misspelt words which editors should be careful of.

accommodate	two c's and two m's
anoint	only one n
battalion	only one l
desiccate	one s, two c's
embarrassment	two r's and two s's
harass	only one r
idiosyncrasy	not idiosyncracy
manoeuvre	not manoeuver
millennium	two l's and two n's
minuscule	not miniscule
octogenarian	not octagenarian
omelette	not ommelette
pavilion	only one l
queuing	not queueing
restaurateur	not restauranteur
sacrilegious	not sacreligious

septuagenarian	not septagenarian
siege	not seige
stratagem	not strategem
stupefied	not stupified
stupefaction	not stupefication
supersede	not supercede
vermilion	only one l

Accented Words

Words originating in European languages (especially French) appear in Roman but with the necessary accents in Penguin India publications (e.g. naïve, vis-à-vis, table d'hôte etc.). Please consult the Oxford Dictionary for Writers and Editors for the correct use of accents.

Place Names

The following are the standardized Penguin India spellings of commonly used place names.

Chandigarh	not Chandigar or Chandhigar
Chennai	not Madras, except in a reference to a time before the renaming.
Dhaka	not Dacca, except in a reference to old British usage.
Ganga	not Ganges
Jalandhar	not Jullandar, Jullender or Jullandhar.
Kanpur	not Cawnpore or Kanpore.
Kochi	not Cochin, except in old usage.
Kolkata	not Calcutta, except in reference to a time before the renaming.

Mumbai not Bombay, except in a reference to a time before the renaming, or in a specifically political refusal to abjure the old name.

Pune not Puna or Poona.

Thiruvananthapuram not Trivandrum, except in old usage